

Text of Kapparot in Hebrew and English

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English

Both

Hebrew

At dawn or early in the morning before Yom Kippur, take a live chicken (a rooster for males, a hen for females), fish or money which will then be given to charity and recite the following three times.

Children of man who sit in darkness and the shadow of death, bound in misery and chains of iron --- He will bring them out of darkness and the shadow of death, and will sunder their bonds. Foolish sinners, afflicted because of their sinful ways and their wrongdoings; their soul loathes all food and they reach the gates of death --- they cry out to the Lord in their distress; He saves them from their afflictions. He sends forth His word and heals them; He delivers them from their graves. Let them thank the Lord for His kindness, and [proclaim] His wonders to the children of man. If there be for a man [even] one interceding angel out of a thousand [accusers], to speak of his uprightness in his behalf, then He will be gracious to him and say: Redeem him from going down to the grave; I have found expiation [for him].

בְּנֵי אָדָם יֹשְׁבֵי חֹשֶׁךְ וְצִלְמוֹת, אֲסִירֵי עָנִי וּבְרָזָל:
יוֹצִיאֵם מִחֹשֶׁךְ וְצִלְמוֹת, וּמוֹסְרוֹתֵיהֶם יִנְתֵּק: אֲוִילִים
מִדֶּרֶךְ פֶּשַׁע, וּמַעֲוֹנוֹתֵיהֶם יִתְעַנו: כָּל-אֶכָּל תִּתְעַב
נַפְשָׁם, וַיִּגְעוּ עַד-שַׁעֲרֵי-מוֹת: וַיִּזְעֻקוּ אֶל-יְיָ בְּצָר
לָהֶם, מִמַּצּוֹקוֹתֵיהֶם יוֹשִׁיעֵם: יִשְׁלַח דְּבָרוֹ וַיִּרְפָּאֵם,
וַיַּמְלֹט מִשְׁחִיתוֹתָם: יוֹדוּ לֵי חֶסֶד, וְנִפְלְאוֹתָיו לִבְנֵי
אָדָם: אִם-יֵשׁ עָלָיו מִלֶּאֶד מְלִיץ, אֶחָד מִנִּי-אֱלֹהִים,
לְהַגִּיד לְאָדָם יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיַּחַנְנוּ, וַיֹּאמְרוּ, פִּדְעָהּ מִיָּד
שַׁחַת, מִצְּאֹתַי כֶּפֶר:

When reciting the words "this is my...", pass the chicken, fish or money over your head three times:

For a Rooster:

This is my exchange, this is my substitute, this is my expiation.
This rooster shall go to death and I shall proceed to a good,
long life and peace.

זֶה חֲלִיפָתִי, זֶה תַּמּוּרָתִי, זֶה כִּפָּרְתִּי, זֶה הַתְּרַנְּגוּל
יֵלֵךְ לְמִיתָה, וְאֲנִי אֵלֶּךְ לְחַיִּים טוֹבִים אֲרוּכִים
וּלְשָׁלוֹם:

For a Hen:

This is my exchange, this is my substitute, this is my expiation.
This hen shall go to death and I shall proceed to a good, long
life and peace.

זֹאת חֲלִיפָתִי, זֹאת תַּמּוּרָתִי, זֹאת כִּפָּרְתִּי, זֹאת
הַתְּרַנְּגוּלָּה תֵּלֵךְ לְמִיתָה, וְאֲנִי אֵלֶּךְ לְחַיִּים טוֹבִים
אֲרוּכִים וּלְשָׁלוֹם:

If Using Money:

This is my exchange, this is my substitute, this is my expiation.
These coins shall go to charity and I shall proceed to a good,
long life and peace.

זֶה חֲלִיפָתִי, זֶה תַּמּוּרָתִי, זֶה כִּפְּרָתִי, אֵלֹהֵי הַמַּעֲוֹת
תִּלְכְּנָה לְצַדִּיקָה, וְאֲנִי אֵלֶּךְ לְחַיִּים טוֹבִים אָרוּכִים
וּלְשָׁלוֹם:

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Kaparot

Yom Kippur

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